

Medical industry plots response to RFK Jr.'s changes

Some see chance at reforms, others a long road back

By Jason Laughlin and Sarah Rahal
GLOBE STAFF

Dr. Brian Chow, an infectious disease specialist, is among the most qualified people in the country to speak about the importance of hepatitis B vaccinations.

He received advanced training at Brown University and was an attending physician at Tufts Medical Center. While there, he witnessed a young patient die of liver cancer that stemmed from a hepatitis B infection, a death that could have been prevented had the man received a common vaccine for the disease as a baby.

That experience moved Chow to urge members of a federal vaccine advisory committee to affirm that all babies should continue to receive a hepatitis B shot shortly after birth. His plea, submitted in a public comment

along with scores of others by physicians, medical societies, and state health directors, went unheeded: On Friday, members of that panel did the opposite, voting to undo more than three decades of vaccination policy that demonstrably reduced cases of hepatitis B in the United States.

The recommendation now awaits approval from Jim O'Neill, deputy secretary of the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention, to become official.

"We will see more cases of chronic hepatitis B," said Chow, who now practices at Harbor-UCLA Medical Center in Los Angeles, in an interview last week. "Cirrhosis or cancer, we'll see more of those cases."

The change to the hepatitis B schedule is the most dramatic step yet in what senior figures in American medicine fear will be a wholesale undoing of not just vaccines, but health policies grounded in evidence-based science, under US Health Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr.

VACCINES, Page A17

What are the best places for employees in Massachusetts? Find out in a special Top Places to Work issue of the **Globe Magazine**.

In 1985, the country wasn't ready to talk about the AIDS crisis; Boston was. Take a look back at what the city did. **SundayArts, N1.**

Buyers may have better luck with condos than houses in Greater Boston. **Address, H1.**

Marquee matches

England, France, and Haiti headline 2026 World Cup tilts in Foxborough. **C1, B1.**



GAMES AT GILLETTE

		Haiti vs. Scotland
		Norway vs. TBD
		Scotland vs. Morocco
		England vs. Ghana
		Norway vs. France

ADOBE STOCK, GETTY IMAGES



Brisk profile

Sunday: Sun and clouds. High: 36-41. Low: 21-26.

Monday: Sunny and cold. High: 27-32. Low: 14-19. Sunrise: 7:00 Sunset: 4:11

Complete report, **A26.**

Deaths, **A20-25.**

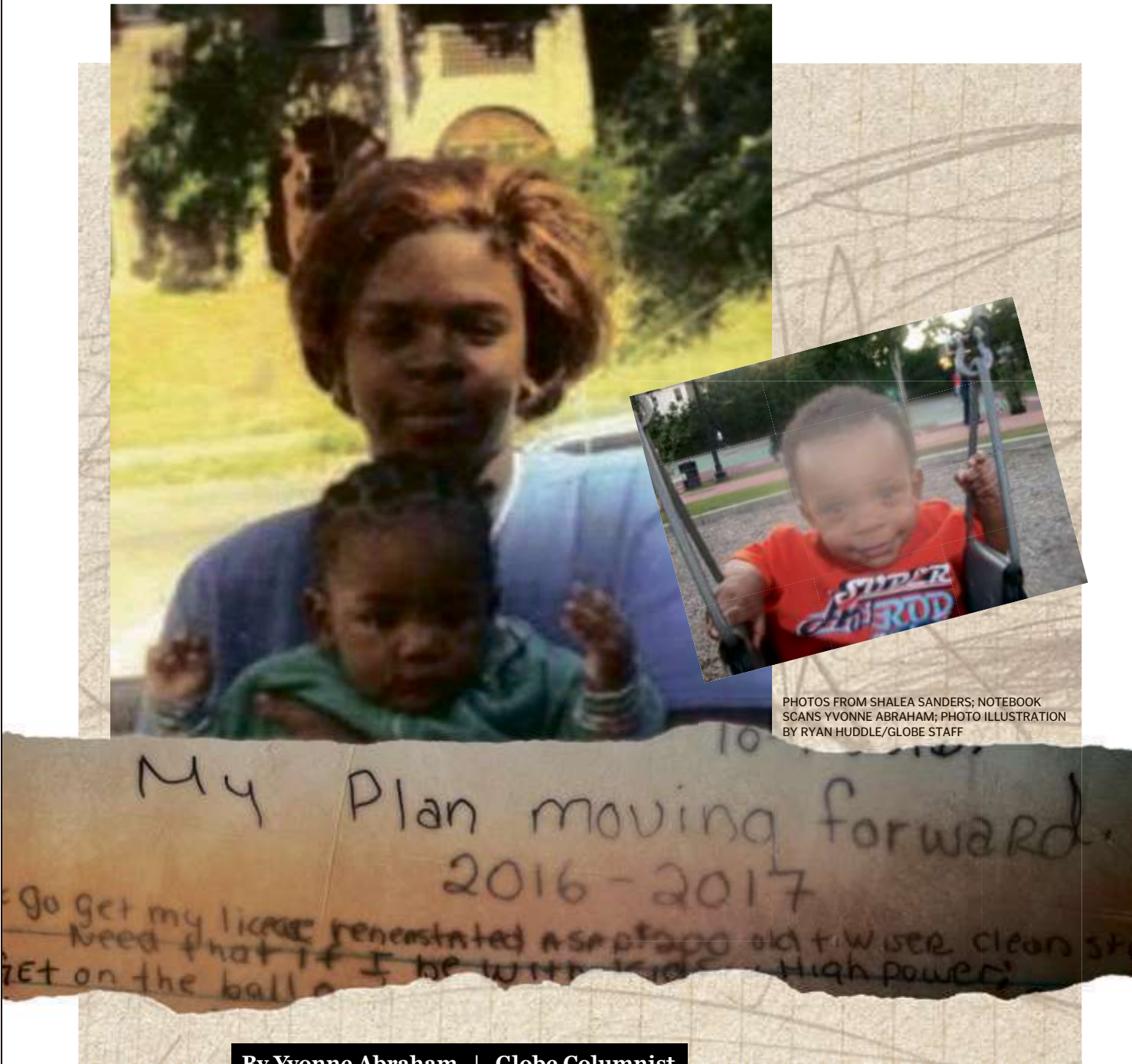
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A mentally ill mother, her violent spiral, and a test of the 'insanity defense'

Torment and Trial | Chapter One

Latarsha Sanders was convicted of first-degree murder for killing her children Marlon, 8, and La'son, 5, in 2018, even though she was experiencing severe symptoms of mental illness at the time. This series explores what led up to the horrific day when Sanders killed her sons, and how the justice system treated Sanders and her family afterward.



By Yvonne Abraham | Globe Columnist

February 2018 ■ The 911 calls came in just after noon on Monday, Feb. 5. A woman was in distress outside a triple-decker on Prospect Street, in Brockton. Her neighbors thought she was having a seizure, but it was clear to the EMTs that Latarsha Sanders was in the midst of a psychiatric episode. She kept saying her son and his father were trying to kill her. She screamed and kicked and flailed when they put her on the stretcher.

Her downstairs neighbor told a police officer that he and his wife knew Sanders, and sometimes babysat her two younger sons, aged 5 and 8. With Sanders in the ambulance on the way to Good Samaritan Hospital, the neighbor said he could watch the boys until their older siblings got home.

He went upstairs with the police officer to check on them, leading the way to a bedroom in the rear of the apartment where a small child lay in a bed.

The neighbor lifted the blanket.

"Oh my God!" he screamed. "Oh my God!"

It's only fair to warn you. This is a tragic and gruesome story. There will be no happy ending. No neat solutions for the ruptures that led up to that awful weekend in 2018. No easy antidotes for the miseries and injustices that came after it.

Might there be a measure of solace for the shattered family at the heart of this? Some way to offset the failings and cruelty that led them all here? That part hasn't been written yet. But we can't get there unless we truly see what happened here, unless we resist the urge to look away.

And anyone with a heart would want to look away.

SANDERS, Page A19

Parents fret for choices as cuts to PBS Kids squeeze quality shows

By Aidan Ryan
GLOBE STAFF

Like many parents, Andrew David keeps a close eye on what programs his 6-year-old son is consuming, often watching shows on YouTube, Netflix, or Disney+ with him or sitting nearby and listening in. But when he looks over and sees the PBS Kids logo, he feels he can stand down.

"It is one thing that we don't have to worry about," said David, 42, a history lecturer at Boston University who lives in Waltham. "It's going to be fine, and more often than not, he's going to like it."

David is among the generations of adults who themselves were weaned on "Mister Rogers' Neighborhood," "Reading Rainbow," and other PBS classics at a

time when public broadcasting's main competition was largely Bugs Bunny and other famous cartoon characters. He's not alone in his confidence in the public broadcaster: A YouGov survey earlier this year found that 88 percent of parents agreed that PBS is a trusted source for kids' shows and games.

KIDS' TV, Page A17



From left: David Newell and Fred Rogers in "Mister Rogers' Neighborhood" and scenes from the animated series "Arthur" and "Weather Hunters."